

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86ROME 024465

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ACTION EUR-00

INFO LOG-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 SS-00 OIC-02 CIAE-00
DUDE-00 FI-01 MMO-01 IO-19 NSCE-00 NSAE-00 SSO-00
L-03 TRSE-00 PM-10 PA-02 INRE-00 ACDA-12 USIE-00
SP-02 PRS-01 /064 W

-----123263 161701Z /46

O 161644Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY ROME
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 5814
INFO NATO COLLECTIVE
AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
AMCONSUL NAPLES
AMCONSUL MILAN
AMCONSUL PALERMO POUCH
AMCONSUL FLORENCE POUCH
AMCONSUL GENOA POUCH
AMCONSUL TURIN POUCH
.....

UNCLAS SECTION 01 OF 02 ROME 24465

E.O. 12356: N/A
TAGS: PREL, PARM, IT, UR
SUBJECT: SPECIAL MOSCOW ENVOY MEETS WITH
- PREMIER CRAXI
.....

REF: ROME 24361 (NOTAL) ✓

1. AS PART OF ITS REYKJAVIK FOLLOW-UP CAMPAIGN, THE
SOVIET UNION'S DEPUTY FOREIGN MINISTER BESSMERTNYK
MET WITH PREMIER CRAXI AND FOREIGN MINISTER ANDREOTTI
(SEPARATELY) ON OCTOBER 15. ACCORDING TO PRESS RE-
PORTING, WHICH APPEARS TO BE BASED IN LARGE PART ON
AN OFFICIAL PRESS COMMUNIQUE, BESSMERTNYK OUTLINED
THE SOVIET PROPOSALS MADE IN ICELAND AND DISCUSSED
THE PROGRESS MADE TOWARD SUBSTANTIAL AND PROGRESSIVE
REDUCTIONS IN NUCLEAR ARMAMENTS. HE STRESSED THE
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CHANGES MADE BY MOSCOW IN ITS NEGOTIATING POSITIONS
TO FURTHER THE TALKS. WHILE ACCEPTING THE CONCEPT
OF NEGOTIATING DIFFERENT ARMS CONTROL ISSUES AT
DIFFERENT PACES, HE INSISTED THAT IN THE END THERE
HAD TO BE INTERDEPENDENCE BETWEEN THE THREE AREAS OF
INF, ICBM, AND SDI.

2. DIALOGUE MUST CONTINUE

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED BY ASM DATE 11/14/87
() REFERENCE () DECLASSIFY
() EXEMPT () DECLASSIFY in PART
() DENY () Non-responsive info.
FOI, EO or PA exemptions _____
TS authority to: _____
() CLASSIFY as _____, OADR
() DOWNGRADE TS to () S or () C, OADR

NOTWITHSTANDING THE MANNER IN WHICH THE ICELAND TALKS ENDED, BESSMERTNYK STRESSED THAT THE NEGOTIATIONS BETWEEN THE TWO SUPERPOWERS MUST CONTINUE. THE OUTCOME IS NOT SURE, BUT THE ROAD TO DIALOGUE IS NOT CLOSED. WHILE THE PRESS GENERALLY TERMED BESSMERTNYK'S VISIT REASSURING, "LA STAMPA" DID NOTE THAT SOURCES IN THE PREMIER'S OFFICE FELT THAT HE HAD NOT BEEN AS OPEN AS KARPOV IN LONDON AND BONN IN DELINKING INF FROM THE OVERALL PACKAGE.

3. ITALIAN RESPONSE

CRAXI TOLD BESSMERTNYK THAT HE WOULD CONTINUE TO WORK FOR A NEW REAGAN-GORBACHEV ENCOUNTER AS SOON AS POSSIBLE TO CONTINUE A "CONSTRUCTIVE DIALOGUE" WHICH WOULD INCLUDE SOI IN ITS AGENDA. CRAXI FELT THAT THE SUPERPOWERS MUST CONTINUE BECAUSE THERE IS GREAT POTENTIAL FOR AGREEMENT. THESE SAME PRESS REPORTS INDICATE BESSMERTNYK WAS PLEASED WITH THIS RESPONSE. IN ITS REPORT, LEFT-LEANING "LA REPUBBLICA" GOES BEYOND THE OFFICIAL COMMUNIQUE TO SUGGEST, CITING A BRIEFING, THAT CRAXI AND ANOREOTTI HOPE THAT MOSCOW AND WASHINGTON CAN WORK TO LIMIT SOI IN THE COMING YEARS TO ONLY "LABORATORY EXPERIMENTS."

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THE BRIEFER ADMITTED THAT ONE MUST ALSO AGREE ON WHAT CONSTITUTES A LABORATORY EXPERIMENT. (COMMENT: WE INTEND TO SEEK CLARIFICATION FROM THE GOI ON THIS POINT.)

4. PRESS CONFERENCE

IN A PRESS CONFERENCE AFTER THE MEETINGS, BESSMERTNYK SAID:

--THAT SOMEONE FROM THE USSR WOULD HAVE COME TO BRIEF ITALY NO MATTER HOW THE REYKJAVIK TALKS ENDED.

--THAT REYKJAVIK WAS AT THE SAME TIME A MATTER OF SATISFACTION AND DISAPPOINTMENT.

- -SATISFACTION BECAUSE FOR THE FIRST TIME THE U.S. AND USSR WERE JUST ONE STEP FROM AGREEMENT TO DESTROY ALL NUCLEAR WEAPONS IN EUROPE WITHIN TEN YEARS.
- -DISAPPOINTMENT BECAUSE THE U.S. HAD BLOCKED SUCH A DEAL BECAUSE IT WOULD NOT BEND ON SOI.

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--THAT THE U.S. WAS NOT READY TO REACH SUCH A
WIDE-RANGING AGREEMENT, AND

--THAT AMERICANS WERE BADLY MISTAKEN IF THEY THOUGHT
THAT THEY COULD ACHIEVE MILITARY SUPERIORITY OVER
THE USSR--IF THE U.S. CONTINUES ALONG THIS PATH,

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	DODE-00	H-01	MMO-01	ID-19	NSCE-00	NSAE-00	SSO-00
	L-03	TRSE-00	PM-10	PA-02	INRE-00	ACDA-12	USIE-00
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RELATIONS WILL BECOME DESTABILIZED.

5. COMMENT: ALL OF THE ABOVE WAS DRAWN FROM THE PRESS
WHICH WAS GENERALLY IMPRESSED BY BESSMERTYNK'S
PERFORMANCE AND REMARKS. WE WILL BE REPORTING MORE
AUTHORITATIVE GOVERNMENT REMARKS BY SEPTELS.

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